



User Manual

Ananya Online Store
Administrator & Customer Guide

Version 1.0 · Laravel 5.4 / PHP 5.6 build
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1. About this system

The Ananya Online Store is a complete e-commerce website with two sides: a public **storefront** where customers browse and buy, and a private **admin dashboard** where you manage the catalogue, stock, orders and customers.

Area	What it is for
Storefront	Home page, shop listing, product pages, cart, checkout
Customer account	Order history, order tracking, profile details
Admin dashboard	Categories, products, stock, orders, customers

Prices are shown in **LKR**. The currency can be changed in the configuration — see section 6.

2. Signing in

2.1 Administrator sign-in

Go to `/login` on your site and enter the administrator details.

Email	admin@ananya.com
Password	admin123

Change this password immediately. These are the credentials the system was delivered with, so anyone who has seen this document can use them. See section 2.3.

Administrators are always taken straight to the Admin Dashboard after signing in — never to the storefront.

2.2 Demo customer account

Email	customer@ananya.com
Password	customer123

This account exists only for testing. Delete it before the shop goes live.

2.3 Changing your password

1. Sign in.
2. Go to `/profile`.
3. Under **Update password**, enter your current password, then the new one twice.
4. Click **Update password**.

You can change your name and email address on the same page.

3. Administrator guide

The admin dashboard is at `/admin`. The menu on the left gives you Dashboard, Categories, Products, Orders and Customers.

3.1 Dashboard

The landing screen summarises the shop at a glance:

- **Total Products** — how many products exist in the catalogue.
- **Total Orders** — every order ever placed.
- **Total Revenue** — the value of orders marked as paid.
- **Total Customers** — registered customer accounts.
- **Recent Orders** — the ten most recent orders; click one to open it.
- **Low Stock Alert** — active products with fewer than 10 units left.

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Store Admin

Total Products
18

Total Orders
2

Total Revenue
LKR 0.00

Total Customers
1

Recent Orders

ORDER #	CUSTOMER	DATE	STATUS	TOTAL
ANZ-1044	Priya Sharma	Sep 29, 2026	Pending	LKR 17,479.
ANZ-1043	Priya Sharma	Sep 29, 2026	Processing	LKR 6,990.0

Low Stock Alert

PRODUCT	SKU
Heavy-Duty 3-Burner Gas R...	RSDBJK
Sowbhagya Tilting Wet Gri...	PYZWO
Commercial Idli Steamer 4...	DW2ST
Brass Nataraja Statue 12"	CV5UAC

The Admin Dashboard

Total Revenue counts paid orders only. A new order starts as *unpaid*, so it will not appear in revenue until its payment status is recorded as paid.

3.2 Category management

Categories group your products (Kitchen Appliances, Brass Statues, and so on).

Adding a category

1. Click **Categories**, then **Add Category**.
2. Enter the **Name**. The web address is generated automatically.

3. Optionally add a **Description** and an **Image** (JPG, PNG, GIF or WebP, up to 2 MB).
4. **Sort order** controls the position in menus — lower numbers appear first.
5. Leave **Active** ticked to show it on the storefront.
6. Click **Save**.

Editing and deleting

Use **Edit** to change any detail; uploading a new image replaces the old one. A category that still contains products **cannot** be deleted — move or delete those products first. This is deliberate, so products never end up orphaned.

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Categories

+ Add Category

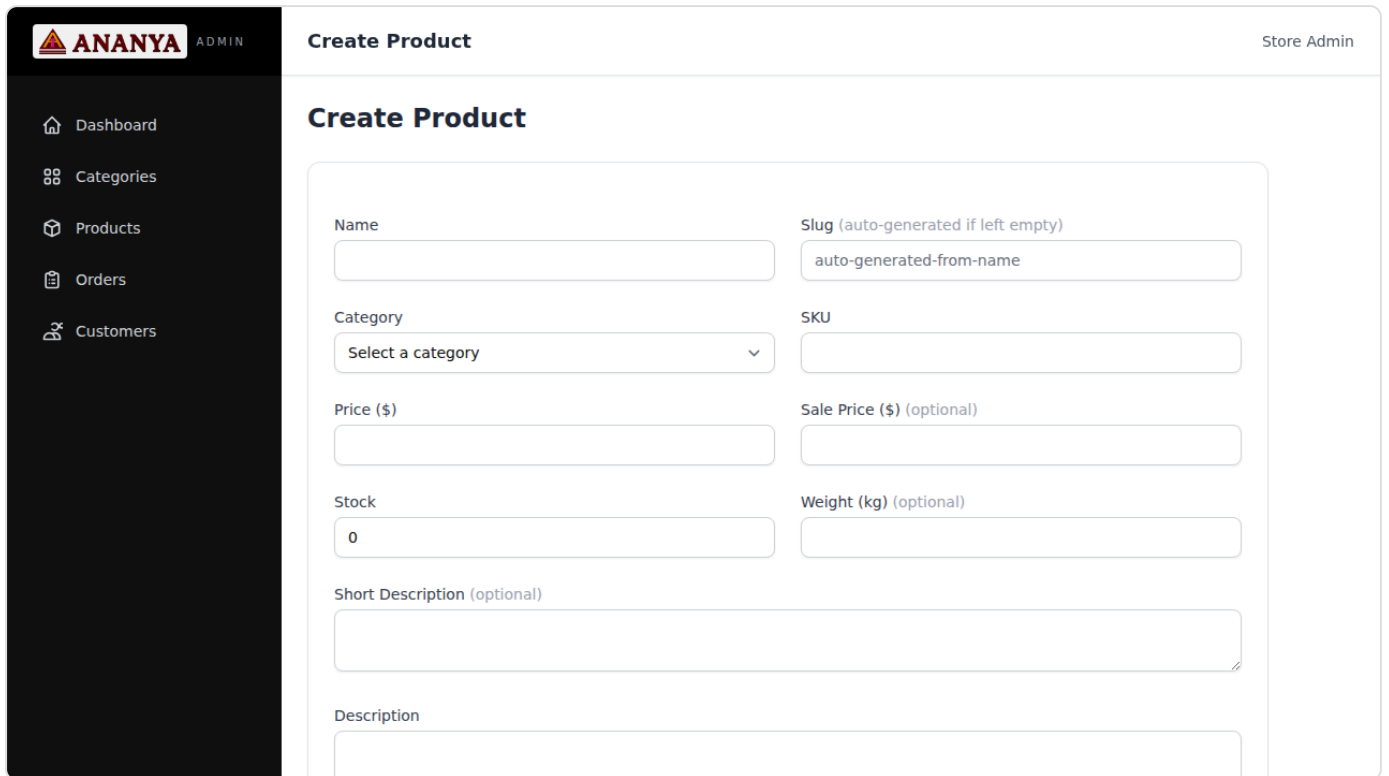
ID	IMAGE	NAME	PRODUCTS	STATUS	ACTIONS
1		Kitchen Appliances	2	Active	Edit Delete
2		Brass Statues	3	Active	Edit Delete
3		Temple Items	4	Active	Edit Delete
4		Hotel Kitchen	3	Active	Edit Delete
5		Sowbhagya Brand	3	Active	Edit Delete
6		Cookware & Utensils	3	Active	Edit Delete

Category list, showing how many products each one holds

3.3 Product management

Adding a product

1. Click **Products**, then **Add Product**.
2. Fill in **Name** and choose a **Category** (both required).
3. **Price** is the normal selling price.
4. **Sale price** is optional. When set, the storefront shows it alongside the original price struck through. It must be lower than the normal price.
5. **Stock** is the number of units available.
6. **SKU** is your own product code. It must be unique if used.
7. **Thumbnail** is the main image shown in listings.
8. **Images** lets you upload several additional photos for the product gallery.
9. **Active** makes it visible; **Featured** also shows it on the home page.
10. Click **Save**.



The screenshot shows the 'Create Product' form in the ANANYA Admin interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with the ANANYA logo and 'ADMIN' text, and a menu with links to Dashboard, Categories, Products, Orders, and Customers. The main content area has a header with 'Create Product' and 'Store Admin'. The form itself is titled 'Create Product' and contains several input fields: 'Name' and 'Slug (auto-generated if left empty)' (with a pre-filled value 'auto-generated-from-name'), 'Category' (a dropdown menu showing 'Select a category'), 'SKU', 'Price (\$)', 'Sale Price (\$) (optional)', 'Stock' (with a value of '0'), and 'Weight (kg) (optional)'. At the bottom are two text areas for 'Short Description (optional)' and 'Description'.

The Add Product form

Finding products

The product list can be searched by name or SKU and filtered by category, active state and featured state.

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Products

Search products...

All Categories

Filter

ID	IMAGE	NAME	CATEGORY	PRICE	STOCK
1		Sowbhagya Table Top Wet Grinde...	Kitchen Appliances	LKR 8,990.00 LKR 6,990.00	21
2		Sowbhagya Mixer Grinder 750W (...)	Kitchen Appliances	LKR 5,490.00 LKR 4,290.00	40
3		Brass Standing Ganesha Idol 9"	Brass Statues	LKR 3,499.00	14
4		Brass Nataraja Statue 12"	Brass Statues	LKR 6,799.00 LKR 5,999.00	8
5		Brass Lakshmi-Ganesha Pair	Brass Statues	LKR 4,299.00	20
6		Traditional Brass Deepam / Diy...	Temple Items	LKR 1,299.00 LKR 999.00	60

Product list with search and filters

Deleting a product

Deleting removes the product and its uploaded images permanently. If you only want to hide it from the shop, untick **Active** instead — that keeps it linked to past orders.

3.4 Stock management

Stock is held on each product and maintained automatically:

- Set the opening quantity in the **Stock** field.
- When a customer places an order, stock is reduced automatically by the quantity bought.
- Products with fewer than 10 units appear in **Low Stock Alert** on the dashboard.
- To restock, edit the product and raise the **Stock** figure.

3.5 Order management

Click **Orders** to see every order, newest first, with its number, customer, date, status, payment status and total. Use the status filter to narrow the list.

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Orders

AllPendingProcessingShippedDeliveredCancelled

ORDER #	CUSTOMER	DATE	ITEMS	STATUS	PAYMENT	TOTAL	ACTION
ANZ-1044	Priya Sharma	Sep 29, 2026		Pending	Unpaid	LKR 17,479.00	View
ANZ-1043	Priya Sharma	Sep 29, 2026		Processing	Unpaid	LKR 6,990.00	View

Order list

Viewing an order

Opening an order shows the items bought, quantities, prices, the order total, the shipping address and contact details, and any note the customer left.

Updating the status

1. Open the order.
2. Choose the new **Status**.
3. Optionally type a **Remark** — a tracking number, a delay explanation, anything useful.
4. Click **Update Status**.

The customer and the administrator are both emailed automatically whenever the status changes.

Status	Meaning
Pending	Order received, not yet actioned. This is the starting state.
Processing	Being picked, packed or prepared.
Shipped	Handed to the courier and on its way.
Delivered	Received by the customer. Counts as completed.
Cancelled	Order will not be fulfilled.

Cancelling an order does **not** put the stock back automatically. If you cancel, edit the product and raise its stock figure by hand.

3.6 Customer management

Customers lists every registered customer with how many orders they have placed and how much they have spent in total. Click a customer to see their contact details, address and full order history; from there you can open any of their orders.

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Customers

Store Admin

Customers

ID	NAME	EMAIL	ORDERS	TOTAL SPENT	JOINED	ACTION
2	Priya Sharma	customer@ananya.com	2	LKR 24,469.00	Sep 29, 2026	View

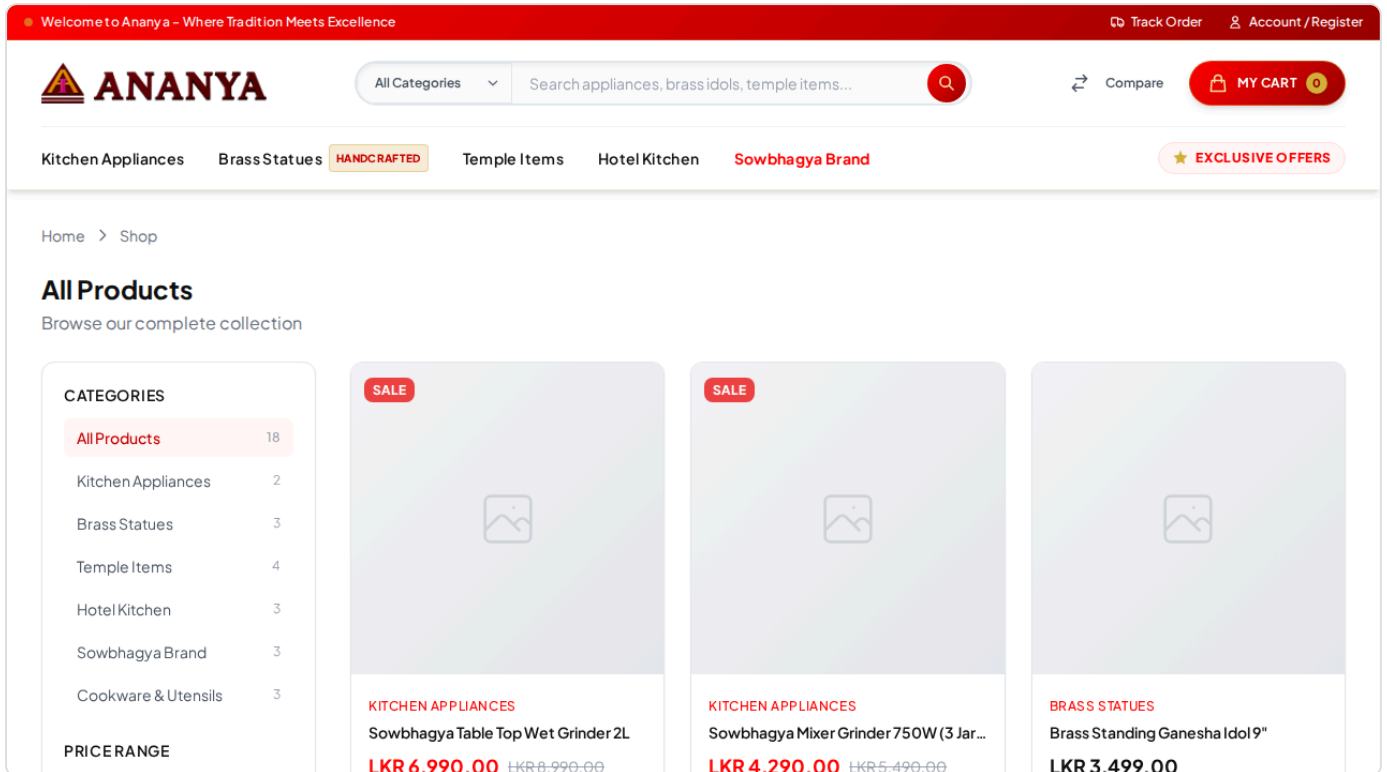
Customer list with order counts and lifetime value

4. Customer guide

This section describes what your customers experience, so you can support them.

4.1 Finding products

- The top menu links to each main category.
- The search box searches product names and descriptions, and can be limited to one category.
- The shop page filters by category and by price range.

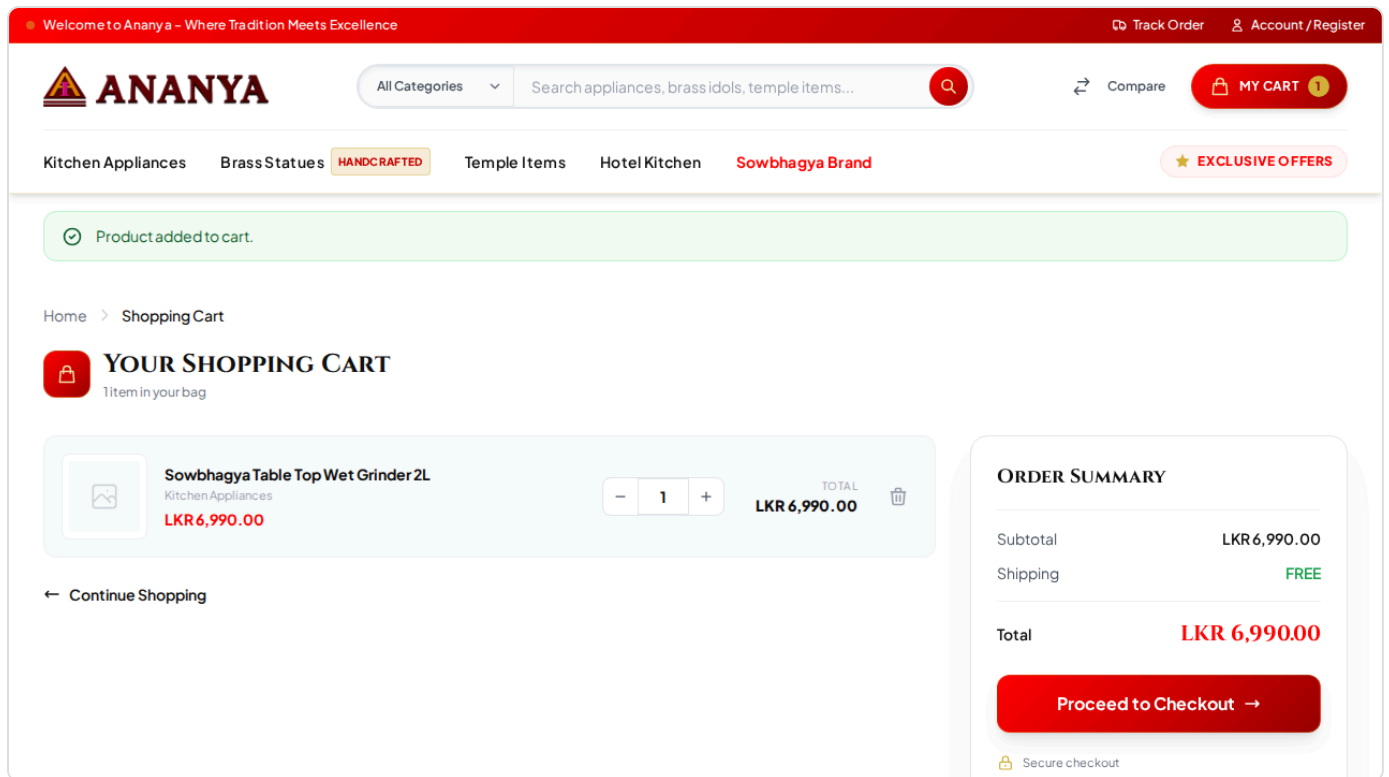


The shop page with category and price filters

4.2 Product page and cart

The product page shows the image gallery, price, stock availability, a full description and related products. The customer chooses a quantity and clicks **Add to Cart**.

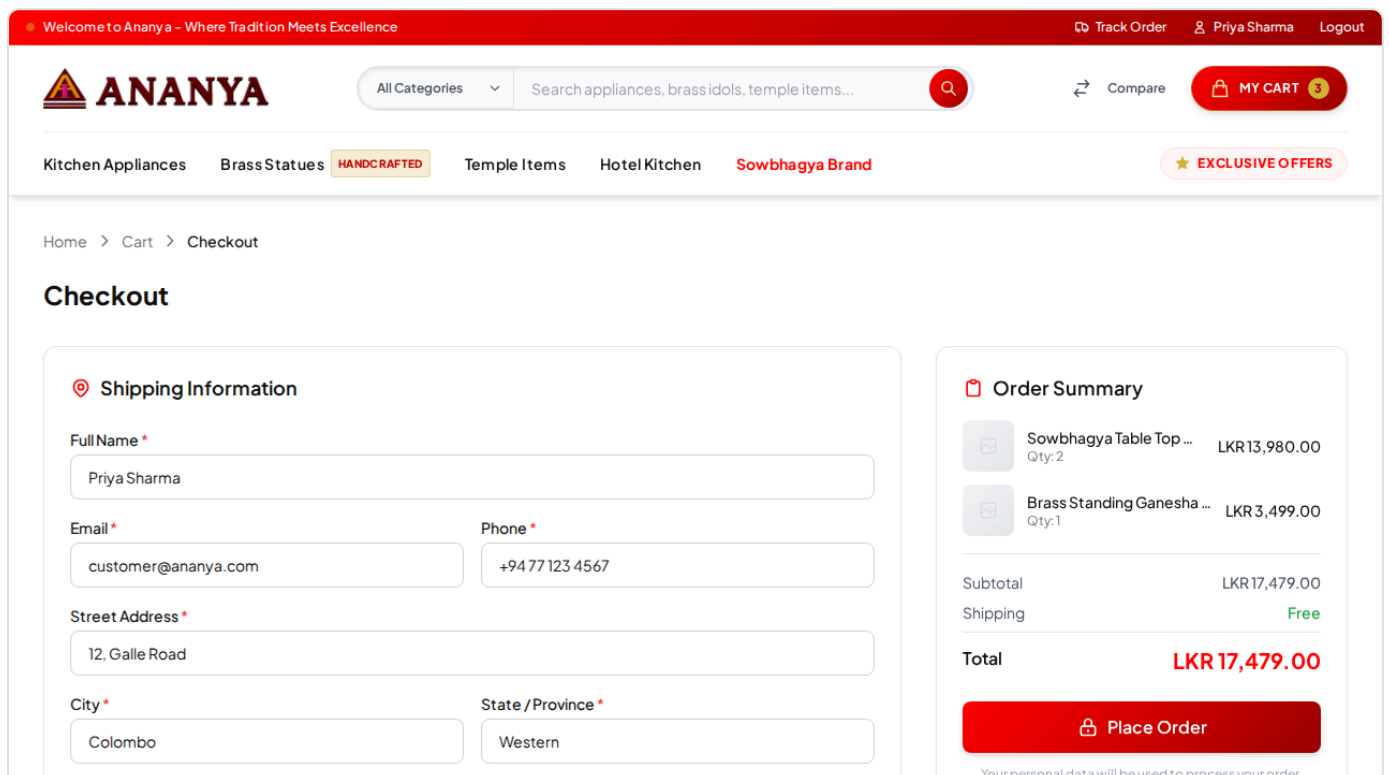
In the cart they can change quantities with the – and + buttons, remove items, and see the order total. Customers can build a cart before signing in; it carries over once they log in.



The shopping cart

4.3 Checkout

Customers must be signed in to check out. They complete the shipping form, review the order summary and click **Place Order**. The order is created, stock is reduced, the cart is emptied and confirmation emails go out to both the customer and the administrator.



Checkout — the summary total is exactly what is charged

4.4 My Account

- **Dashboard** — totals for orders placed, pending, completed and spent.
- **Orders** — full order history; click any order to see its items and current status.
- **Profile** — name, email, phone and address, used to pre-fill checkout.

5. Email notifications

The system sends four emails automatically, using the server's own mail facility. No external mail service is required.

When	Who receives it
An order is placed	The customer — confirmation with order number, date, items, total and status
An order is placed	The administrator — new-order alert with contact details and a link to manage it
An order's status changes	The customer — previous status, new status, date and time, and your remark
An order's status changes	The administrator — the same details, for your records

The administrator address is set by `ADMIN_EMAIL` in the configuration file. Change it to the inbox that should receive order alerts.

If emails are not arriving, check the junk folder first, then confirm with your hosting provider that PHP's `mail()` function is enabled on the account. A mail failure is recorded in the log and never blocks an order from being placed.

6. Store settings

These live in the `.env` file in the root of the application. Edit it, save, and the change takes effect on the next page load.

Setting	What it does
<code>APP_NAME</code>	Store name shown in the header, emails and page titles
<code>STORE_CURRENCY</code>	Currency shown in front of every price (currently <code>LKR</code>)
<code>STORE_TAGLINE</code>	The line in the top bar of the storefront
<code>ADMIN_EMAIL</code>	Inbox that receives order and status-change alerts
<code>MAIL_FROM_ADDRESS</code>	The "from" address on outgoing emails
<code>APP_DEBUG</code>	Must be <code>false</code> on a live site

If you edit `.env` and nothing changes, delete the file `bootstrap/cache/config.php` if it exists. While that file is present the application ignores `.env` completely.

7. Security checklist

Before announcing the shop publicly:

1. Change the administrator password (section 2.3).
2. Delete the demo customer account.
3. Set `APP_DEBUG=false` and `APP_ENV=production` . With debug on, any error shows visitors a detailed technical page.
4. Set `ADMIN_EMAIL` to a monitored inbox.
5. Confirm the site is served over **https**.
6. Arrange regular database backups with your host.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
A product does not appear in the shop	Check that Active is ticked, and that its category is also active.
A product is missing from the home page	The home page shows Featured products. Edit the product and tick Featured.
Revenue looks too low	Revenue counts orders whose payment status is <i>paid</i> . Unpaid orders are excluded.
A category will not delete	It still contains products. Move or delete those products first.
Order emails are not arriving	Check junk mail, verify <code>ADMIN_EMAIL</code> , then confirm with your host that <code>mail()</code> is enabled.
Changing <code>.env</code> has no effect	Delete <code>bootstrap/cache/config.php</code> .
Images do not display after upload	The <code>storage</code> folder must be writable, and <code>public/storage</code> must link to <code>storage/app/public</code> .
"The only supported ciphers are..."	The application key is missing or the wrong length. Run <code>php keygen.php --write</code> in the application folder.